

the window on another floor. This will also make your network more inviting to external entities.

The second access point will have to be configured in repeater mode, which means it will work as a range extender, and therefore will need connectivity with the main access point. Therefore, the placement of second access point will have to be such that it is within the range of first access point.

Equipment Planning

Equipment planning can be done only when you are clear as to how many PCs are going to be connected, and what your data throughput requirements are. What kind of equipment is required will also need you to take into consideration the kind of hardware you will be connecting. For example, a PC will need a PCI Wi-Fi card, whereas a laptop will need a PCMCIA-based Wi-fi card (if it is not already Wi-fi-enabled).

If you are going to use a dial-up connection to connect to the Internet, you will not need a wireless router, but if you are going to connect to the Internet using a cable connection or a DSL line, a wireless broadband router is your best option.

A router will let you plug the cable coming in from the service provider directly to it, bypassing the PC completely. This helps in placement of both the PC and the broadband router, because you don't have to run long cables coming all the way to the PC. This is especially true if you are staying in a ground plus one house or a duplex flat, where



A 4-port switch